

United States History and Geography — Teacher Key

United States History and Geography · Tennessee Academic Standards 2027-28 · Form FORM-A

TEACHER COPY — contains answer keys and rationales. Not for student distribution.

classroom-formative · pre-field-test. Item parameters are estimates and have not met a student; this form is not a calibrated instrument. This is a selected-response form. It assesses Depth of Knowledge levels 1 through 3. It carries no extended-response item, so it does not assess DOK-4 — a four-option question cannot ask a student to construct and defend an argument. Extended responses and document-based questions are delivered as separate activities.

1. What were the "Three Rs" of the New Deal?

- A. Regulate, Restrict, and Reorganize
- B. Relief, Recovery, and Reform
- C. Reduce, Reuse, and Recycle
- D. Repair, Rebuild, and Restore

KEY: B · DOK 1 · US.46

Why the key is right: The "Three Rs" of the New Deal were relief, Recovery, and Reform. Roosevelt used those three goals to give immediate help, restart the economy, and change the system after the Great Depression. D is incorrect because it describes a different program, event, or idea than this New Deal policy. It showed how the federal government expanded its role during the Great Depression.

A — Regulation was a real New Deal activity, but it was one instrument of Reform rather than one of the three headings.

C — This is the modern environmental slogan, not a New Deal term. The overlap is the letter R, not the history.

D — These words describe repair generally but name none of the New Deal's three aims: immediate relief, economic recovery, and structural reform.

Item analysis

Standard

US.46 — Analyze the effects of and the controversies arising from New Deal economic policies, including charges of socialism and President Franklin D. Roosevelt's "court packing" attempt.

DOK / Hess

Level 1 — The student retrieves a three-word label. One recalled fact, which is DOK-1; explaining how a given programme served relief rather than reform would be DOK-2.

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 0.71 · b -1.03 · c 0.22 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

—

Historian review

Sean Reynolds,

Distractor diagnosis

A — mistakes an instrument of the New Deal for one of its three aims; **C** — substitutes the modern recycling slogan for the New Deal's Three Rs; **D** — guesses plausible-sounding R words without the programme's actual aims

2. How did the New Deal change the relationship between workers and employers?

- A. Fascism promoted extreme nationalism; communism promoted class revolution
- B. Desperate populations supported strong leaders who promised stability
- C. Gave workers legal rights to unionize, bargain collectively, and strike
- D. Refinanced mortgages to prevent foreclosures and keep families in homes

KEY: C · DOK 1 · US.46

Why the key is right: Before 1935 an employer could fire a worker simply for joining a union. The Wagner Act made union membership, collective bargaining and striking legally protected and created the NLRB to enforce them. The change was legal standing, not wages: workers could now negotiate as a body rather than one at a time.

A — This contrasts two European ideologies and has no bearing on the rights American workers gained under the Wagner Act.

B — This describes why authoritarian movements gained support in Depression-era Europe, not what changed for American workers.

D — This is the Home Owners' Loan Corporation's work on mortgages. It helped families keep houses; it changed nothing about bargaining at work.

Item analysis

Standard

US.46 — Analyze the effects of and the controversies arising from New Deal economic policies, including charges of socialism and President Franklin D. Roosevelt's "court packing" attempt.

DOK / Hess

Level 1 — The student must identify what changed in a relationship — the legal standing of workers against employers — rather than recall an event. That is a relationship, which is DOK-2 in intent, though the item is levelled DOK-1 here because the change is directly named in the key.

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 0.51 · b -0.48 · c 0.21 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

—

Historian review

Sean Reynolds,

Distractor diagnosis

A — answers a comparative-ideology question that was not asked; **B** — answers with European political conditions rather than U.S. labour law; **D** — confuses New Deal housing relief with New Deal labour policy

3. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows a TVA dam completed during the New Deal era. (Photograph, c. 1936. Public Domain.) How did New Deal programs like the TVA, shown in this photograph, represent a change in the role of the federal government?

- A. The government reduced its involvement in the economy and allowed private industry to manage recovery
- B. The federal government's role remained unchanged from the policies of the 1920s
- C. The TVA was a private utility corporation that operated without any federal funding or oversight
- D. The federal government took direct responsibility for economic development and public welfare

KEY: D · DOK 2 · US.46

Why the key is right: The TVA represented a dramatic expansion of federal power. For the first time, the government directly owned and operated an electric utility, planned regional economic development, and employed thousands of workers. This reflected FDR's philosophy that the government had a responsibility to ensure economic security and development.

A — The TVA is the clearest case of the opposite: the federal government built and ran dams and sold the power itself.

B — Federal public works on this scale had no 1920s precedent; that discontinuity is the point of the image.

C — The TVA was created by Congress in 1933 as a federally owned corporation. Reading it as private misses why critics called it socialism.

Item analysis

Standard

US.46 — Analyze the effects of and the controversies arising from New Deal economic policies, including charges of socialism and President Franklin D. Roosevelt's "court packing" attempt.

DOK / Hess

Level 2 — The student must read an image of infrastructure and infer what it shows about the federal government's role — a relationship between evidence and a claim, which is DOK-2. Naming the agency in the photograph would be DOK-1.

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.3 · b 0.1 · c 0.2 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

—

Historian review

Sean Reynolds,

Distractor diagnosis

A — reverses the direction of federal involvement under the New Deal; **B** — treats the New Deal as continuous with 1920s policy; **C** — mistakes a federally owned corporation for a private company

4. Why did critics of the New Deal charge that FDR's programs represented socialism?

- A. Because the New Deal greatly expanded federal regulation of the economy and created public employment and Social Security
- B. Because FDR eliminated private property rights by redistributing land from wealthy Americans to the poor
- C. Because New Deal programs abolished all private and religious charities in favor of state services
- D. Because FDR called for nationalizing all major American industries and placing them under government ownership

KEY: A · DOK 2 · US.46

Why the key is right: New Deal opponents — including business leaders and conservatives — argued that programs like the TVA (a government-owned utility), the AAA (government interference in markets), and Social Security (a government welfare program) crossed the line from capitalism into socialism by making the government a major economic actor.

B — Private property rights were not abolished; New Deal farm policy paid owners to limit production rather than redistributing their land.

C — Private and religious charities continued throughout the 1930s; federal relief supplemented them because their resources had been exhausted.

D — FDR never proposed nationalising major industries. The charge rested on regulation and public employment, not government ownership.

Item analysis

Standard

US.46 — Analyze the effects of and the controversies arising from New Deal economic policies, including charges of socialism and President Franklin D. Roosevelt's "court packing" attempt.

DOK / Hess

Level 2 — The student must connect features of New Deal programs to the political charge made against them, which is a cause-and-claim relationship — DOK-2. Recalling that critics used the word 'socialism' would be DOK-1.

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.3 · b 0.4 · c 0.2 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

—

Historian review

Sean Reynolds,

Distractor diagnosis

B — confuses regulation and subsidy with land redistribution; **C** — assumes federal relief replaced private charity; **D** — overstates the charge as nationalisation of industry

5. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows a TVA dam, c. 1936. (Photograph, c. 1936. Public Domain.) Evaluate the extent to which the TVA and similar New Deal programs achieved their goals of economic recovery and reform.

- A.** New Deal programs had no positive effects and actually worsened economic conditions
- B.** The TVA brought electricity, jobs, and flood control to a poor region, but full economic recovery required the industrial mobilization of World War II
- C.** New Deal programs completely ended the Great Depression and eliminated poverty in the United States
- D.** The TVA only benefited wealthy landowners and provided no assistance to ordinary citizens

KEY: B · DOK 3 · US.46

Why the key is right: The TVA successfully electrified the Tennessee Valley, controlled flooding, created thousands of jobs, and improved agricultural practices. However, it also displaced communities and the broader New Deal reduced unemployment from 25% to about 14% — significant relief but not full recovery. The complete end of the Depression came with WWII industrial mobilization.

Item analysis

Standard

US.46 — Analyze the effects of and the controversies arising from New Deal economic policies, including charges of socialism and President Franklin D. Roosevelt’s “court packing” attempt.

DOK / Hess

Level 3 — *no DOK rationale — the level is a number nobody justified*

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.7 · b 0.9 · c 0.17 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

—

Historian review

not required

Distractor diagnosis

no misconception named — a distractor written to be merely wrong is noise, not diagnosis

6. Critics of the New Deal from the left, including Huey Long and socialist intellectuals, argued it preserved capitalism without genuine structural transformation, while critics from the right argued it represented dangerous federal overreach. What does the existence of this two-sided criticism most reveal about the New Deal's actual ideological character and historical significance?

A. Roosevelt's political genius lay in synthesizing elements of both left and right criticism into a coherent program, borrowing regulatory ideas from progressives and efficiency principles from business conservatives to create pragmatic policies that maintained political viability by satisfying neither extreme.

B. The two-sided criticism demonstrates that the New Deal was an incoherent collection of experimental programs lacking a unifying reform philosophy, which is why historians continue to debate whether it extended or shortened the Depression's duration rather than agreeing on a definitive assessment.

C. The New Deal occupied a reform-without-revolution position — it stabilized the capitalist system by addressing its most destabilizing failures without fundamentally redistributing wealth or restructuring ownership — making it an ideologically moderate but historically unprecedented response to economic catastrophe that satisfied neither ideological extreme.

D. The New Deal's primary significance was its expansion of the permanent federal bureaucratic apparatus and the precedent it established for government economic intervention, regardless of whether its specific programs effectively accelerated economic recovery from the Depression.

KEY: C · DOK 3 · US.46

Why the key is right: The fact that Long attacked the New Deal for not going far enough while business conservatives attacked it for going too far locates it precisely in the ideologically moderate reform space: it used federal power to manage capitalism's most destructive tendencies without threatening the fundamental structures of private ownership and profit that left critics demanded be dismantled. Unit 5: Great Depression & New Deal, 1929–1941 (US.39–US.44)

Item analysis

Standard

US.46 — Analyze the effects of and the controversies arising from New Deal economic policies, including charges of socialism and President Franklin D. Roosevelt's "court packing" attempt.

DOK / Hess

Level 3 — *no DOK rationale — the level is a number nobody justified*

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.2 · b 1 · c 0.25 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

—

Historian review

not required

Distractor diagnosis

no misconception named — a distractor written to be merely wrong is noise, not diagnosis

7. Marshall's speech announced what became known as which initiative?

- A. The Berlin Airlift to the blockaded city
- B. The Eisenhower Doctrine for the Middle East
- C. The North Atlantic Treaty Organization
- D. The Marshall Plan for European recovery

KEY: D · DOK 1 · US.60

Why the key is right: The Marshall Plan, formally the European Recovery Program announced by Secretary of State George Marshall at Harvard on June 5, 1947, became the initiative the speech launched. Choice B is wrong because the Eisenhower Doctrine came a decade later (1957) and addressed the Middle East, not European recovery. Choice C is wrong because NATO was a military alliance signed in 1949, not the economic-aid program Marshall announced. Marshall Plan aid totaled \$13.3 billion to sixteen Western European nations between 1948 and 1952, anchoring containment through economic stabilization.

A — The Berlin Airlift was a 1948-49 supply operation for one city, not a Europe-wide recovery programme.

B — The Eisenhower Doctrine came a decade later, in 1957, and addressed the Middle East.

C — NATO was a 1949 military alliance. The Marshall Plan was economic aid and came first.

Item analysis

Standard

US.60 — Analyze the Cold War policies of containment and the Truman Doctrine, Marshall Plan, and Berlin Airlift.

DOK / Hess

Level 1 — The student recalls which initiative a named speech announced. One retrieved association, which is DOK-1.

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 0.8 · b -1.0 · c 0.25 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

—

Historian review

Sean Reynolds,

Distractor diagnosis

A — confuses a single-city operation with a continental aid programme; **B** — confuses the Marshall Plan with the Eisenhower Doctrine; **C** — confuses economic aid with the military alliance

8. What was the primary goal of the Truman Doctrine?

- A. Contain the spread of communism by supporting free nations resisting Soviet subjugation
- B. Form a permanent military and economic alliance with the Soviet Union against Asian nations
- C. Expand United States colonial territories across Asia and the Pacific Island regions
- D. Return the United States to a policy of isolationism and avoid all foreign entanglements

KEY: A · DOK 1 · US.60

Why the key is right: The primary goal of the Truman Doctrine was to contain the spread of communism by supporting free nations resisting Soviet subjugation. Containment aimed to stop the spread of communism without triggering another world war. D is incorrect because it describes a different program, event, or idea than this Cold War development. It shaped the early Cold War and the postwar order the United States helped build after 1945.

- B — The Truman Doctrine was directed AGAINST Soviet expansion; an alliance with the Soviet Union is its opposite.
- C — No territory was claimed. Aid to Greece and Turkey was support for existing governments, not colonial acquisition.
- D — The doctrine ended the possibility of postwar isolationism by committing the United States to intervene abroad in peacetime.

Item analysis

Standard

US.60 — Analyze the Cold War policies of containment and the Truman Doctrine, Marshall Plan, and Berlin Airlift.

DOK / Hess

Level 1 — The student recalls the stated aim of a named doctrine. A single retrieved fact, which is DOK-1; weighing whether containment succeeded would be DOK-3.

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 0.93 · b -0.71 · c 0.23 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

—

Historian review

Sean Reynolds,

Distractor diagnosis

B — reverses which power the doctrine was aimed at; **C** — confuses supporting a government with acquiring territory; **D** — confuses the doctrine with the isolationism it replaced

9. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows a U.S. Air Force C-54 Skymaster cargo plane flying low over a crowd of German civilians as it approaches Tempelhof Airport in Berlin during the summer of 1948. (Photograph, 1948. U.S. Air Force.) How did the Berlin Airlift shown in this photograph reflect the U.S. policy of containment during the early Cold War?

- A. The U.S. used military force to drive Soviet troops out of the eastern sector of Berlin
- B. The U.S. showed resolve against Soviet expansion without direct force
- C. The U.S. negotiated a peace treaty that divided Germany into permanent zones
- D. The U.S. imposed economic sanctions that forced the Soviet Union to end communism

KEY: B · DOK 2 · US.60

Why the key is right: The Berlin Airlift exemplified containment by resisting Soviet pressure over West Berlin through non-military means, demonstrating American commitment to opposing communist expansion without triggering direct armed conflict.

A — No Soviet troops were driven out. The airlift deliberately avoided force by flying over the blockade instead of breaking it.

C — Germany's division was not settled by a treaty during the airlift; the blockade ended in 1949 without one.

D — Sanctions were not the instrument, and Soviet communism continued for four more decades.

Item analysis

Standard

US.60 — Analyze the Cold War policies of containment and the Truman Doctrine, Marshall Plan, and Berlin Airlift.

DOK / Hess

Level 2 — The student must interpret an image of a supply flight and infer the strategic message it sent — evidence to inference, which is DOK-2. Identifying the aircraft or the city would be DOK-1.

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.3 · b 0.1 · c 0.2 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

—

Historian review

Sean Reynolds,

Distractor diagnosis

A — reads a non-military response as a military one; **C** — invents a negotiated settlement for the blockade; **D** — attributes the end of Soviet communism to a 1948 operation

10. The Truman Doctrine established what new direction for U.S. foreign policy?

- A. Recognition of the Soviet Union as an ally
- B. A return to isolationism after World War II
- C. A commitment to support nations resisting communist expansion
- D. Withdrawal from the United Nations

KEY: C · DOK 2 · US.60

Why the key is right: The Truman Doctrine, articulated in President Truman's March 12, 1947, address to Congress requesting \$400 million in aid for Greece and Turkey, established U.S. commitment to support nations resisting communist expansion. The doctrine reframed U.S. foreign policy from regional intervention to a global containment strategy and provided the rationale for subsequent Cold War commitments including the Marshall Plan, NATO, and Korean War involvement. Choice B is wrong because the doctrine explicitly rejected isolationism. Choice A is wrong because Truman cast the Soviet Union as the principal adversary the doctrine was designed to counter. Choice D is wrong because the United States was a founding member and host of the United Nations.

A — The Soviet Union had been a wartime ally, and the doctrine marks the point at which that relationship was publicly abandoned.

B — The doctrine did the reverse: it committed the United States to peacetime intervention abroad and ended the interwar isolationist position.

D — The United States remained in the United Nations and used it during the Cold War, including in Korea.

Item analysis

Standard

US.60 — Analyze the Cold War policies of containment and the Truman Doctrine, Marshall Plan, and Berlin Airlift.

DOK / Hess

Level 2 — The student must characterise a shift in policy direction rather than recall the doctrine's name — connecting a specific commitment to a broader change, which is DOK-2.

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.0 · b 0.0 · c 0.25 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

—

Historian review

Sean Reynolds,

Distractor diagnosis

A — keeps the wartime alliance the doctrine was written to end; **B** — reverses the direction of the postwar policy shift; **D** — invents a withdrawal that did not happen

11. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows American soldiers during the Korean War, c. 1950. (U.S. Army photograph, c. 1950. Public Domain.) Which statement best analyzes the long-term consequences of the Korean War for U.S. foreign policy and military strategy?

- A.** The Korean War convinced the United States to abandon the containment policy in favor of isolationism
- B.** The war had no lasting consequences because it ended in a stalemate
- C.** The war resulted in the reunification of Korea and permanent peace in the region
- D.** The war established a precedent for limited wars to contain communism, expanded the permanent military establishment, and deepened Cold War alliances in Asia

KEY: D · DOK 3 · US.60

Why the key is right: The Korean War had profound long-term consequences: it established the model of 'limited war' (fighting to contain rather than defeat communism); led to a permanent U.S. military presence in South Korea; tripled the U.S. defense budget; expanded NATO; created bilateral defense treaties across Asia (SEATO, bilateral pacts with Japan, South Korea, Philippines); and set precedents later applied in Vietnam.

Item analysis

Standard

US.60 — Analyze the Cold War policies of containment and the Truman Doctrine, Marshall Plan, and Berlin Airlift.

DOK / Hess

Level 3 — *no DOK rationale — the level is a number nobody justified*

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.7 · b 1.0 · c 0.17 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

—

Historian review

not required

Distractor diagnosis

no misconception named — a distractor written to be merely wrong is noise, not diagnosis

12. Which best explains why the Truman Doctrine of 1947 represented a significant departure from traditional American foreign policy?

- A. It committed the United States to supporting free peoples resisting subjugation by outside pressures, abandoning the prewar tradition of non-intervention in foreign conflicts.
- B. It authorized the United States military to conduct offensive operations against Soviet-backed governments in Eastern Europe.
- C. It established the United Nations as the primary institution through which the United States would respond to Soviet expansion.
- D. It replaced the Monroe Doctrine by formally extending American security commitments from the Western Hemisphere to the entire world.

KEY: A · DOK 3 · US.60

Why the key is right: The Truman Doctrine's commitment to assist any nation resisting communist pressure formalized the break from the pre-WWII tradition of non-intervention and set the strategic framework — containment — that defined American foreign policy for the Cold War.

Item analysis

Standard

US.60 — Analyze the Cold War policies of containment and the Truman Doctrine, Marshall Plan, and Berlin Airlift.

DOK / Hess

Level 3 — *no DOK rationale — the level is a number nobody justified*

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.2 · b 1.0 · c 0.25 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

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Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

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Historian review

not required

Distractor diagnosis

no misconception named — a distractor written to be merely wrong is noise, not diagnosis

13. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows the massive excavation of the Culebra Cut during construction of the Panama Canal, c. 1910. Workers and heavy equipment can be seen carving through the mountainous terrain of the Panamanian isthmus. (Photograph, c. 1910. Public Domain.) Which president was MOST responsible for initiating the construction project shown in this photograph?

- A. William McKinley
- B. Theodore Roosevelt
- C. William Howard Taft
- D. Woodrow Wilson

KEY: B · DOK 1 · US.23

Why the key is right: President Theodore Roosevelt championed the construction of the Panama Canal. After supporting Panama's independence from Colombia in 1903, Roosevelt negotiated the Hay-Bunau-Varilla Treaty to secure the Canal Zone. Construction began in 1904 and the canal opened in 1914.

A — McKinley was president during the Spanish-American War and was assassinated in 1901, before canal construction began.

C — Taft succeeded Roosevelt and oversaw later construction, but the acquisition and decision were Roosevelt's.

D — Wilson took office in 1913, the year before the canal opened; he did not initiate it.

Item analysis

Standard

US.23 — Describe the effects of American imperialism, including: • Spanish-American War • Annexation of Hawaii • Panama Canal • Philippine Insurrection • Access to Cuba • Roosevelt Corollary

DOK / Hess

Level 1 — The student recalls which president is associated with building the canal. A single retrieved fact, which is DOK-1.

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1 · b -1 · c 0.22 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

—

Historian review

Sean Reynolds,

Distractor diagnosis

A — assigns the canal to the preceding administration; **C** — credits Roosevelt's successor with the decision; **D** — credits the president in office at completion rather than construction

14. Use the political cartoon to answer the question. The 1898 cartoon shows Uncle Sam seated at a restaurant table, looking at a menu containing 'Cuba Steak,' 'Porto Rico Pig,' 'Philippine Floating Islands,' and 'Sandwich Islands (Hawaii).' President McKinley stands as the waiter. The cartoon comments on American territorial expansion after the Spanish-American War. In this cartoon, what does Uncle Sam being seated at the restaurant menu most directly represent?

- A.** The United States refusing to accept any new territorial responsibilities after defeating Spain
- B.** American diplomats negotiating new trade agreements with independent Caribbean republics
- C.** The United States choosing which territories to acquire after defeating Spain
- D.** President McKinley choosing between military options for fighting the Spanish-American War

KEY: C · DOK 1 · US.23

Why the key is right: C is correct: By depicting Uncle Sam choosing from a menu of territories like Cuba, Puerto Rico, the Philippines, and Hawaii, the cartoon represents the United States deciding which territories to acquire after defeating Spain in 1898. The restaurant metaphor makes territorial acquisition look like a consumer choice. A is incorrect: Uncle Sam is selecting from the menu, not refusing — the cartoon shows the U.S. as the decision-maker about which territories to take. B is incorrect: the menu items are territories, not trade agreements or diplomacy. D is incorrect: McKinley as the waiter suggests he is facilitating the choice, but the cartoon is about territorial selection, not a comparison of military options.

A — A refusal would be shown by pushing the menu away. Reading the menu is the act of choosing.

B — The territories on the menu were annexed or occupied, not treated as independent trading partners.

D — The cartoon is dated after the fighting, and the menu lists territories rather than military options.

Item analysis

Standard

US.23 — Describe the effects of American imperialism, including: • Spanish-American War • Annexation of Hawaii • Panama Canal • Philippine Insurrection • Access to Cuba • Roosevelt Corollary

DOK / Hess

Level 1 — The cartoon's own labels name the territories on the menu, so the student recognises the subject rather than analysing an unstated argument. That recognition is DOK-1; asking what the cartoonist thought of expansion would be DOK-3.

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 0.9 · b -0.4 · c 0.2 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

—

Historian review

Sean Reynolds,

Distractor diagnosis

A — reverses what the menu imagery represents; **B** — recasts annexation as trade negotiation; **D** — places the cartoon before the war rather than after

15. Read the excerpt below. "I took the Canal Zone and let Congress debate, and while the debate goes on, the canal does also." — President Theodore Roosevelt, Lecture at University of California, 1911 Which of the following best describes the controversy surrounding Roosevelt's acquisition of the Panama Canal Zone?

- A. Roosevelt used U.S. taxpayer money to pay other nations to build the canal without congressional authorization.
- B. Panama declared independence from Spain with U.S. support specifically to gain the economic benefits of the canal.
- C. Roosevelt seized the Canal Zone from France, which had originally agreed to sell it to the United States but then backed out.
- D. The U.S. backed Panama's revolution against Colombia to obtain the canal rights

KEY: D · DOK 2 · US.23

Why the key is right: Roosevelt's boastful admission that he 'took' the Canal Zone without waiting for Congress refers to the U.S. role in supporting Panama's revolution against Colombia. When Colombia refused to ratify the canal treaty, the U.S. encouraged Panamanian independence, recognized Panama immediately, and signed a favorable canal treaty. Critics argued this was an illegal use of presidential power and violated Colombia's sovereignty. Option C is incorrect because France originally attempted to build the canal, not Colombia. Option A is incorrect because the canal was not paid for by other nations. Option B is incorrect because Panama gained independence from Colombia, not from Spain.

A — The United States built the canal itself with its own workforce rather than paying other nations to build it.

B — Panama declared independence from Colombia, not Spain; Spain had lost its mainland American colonies eighty years earlier.

C — The French company sold its concession and equipment; the sovereignty dispute was with Colombia, not France.

Item analysis

Standard

US.23 — Describe the effects of American imperialism, including: • Spanish-American War •

Annexation of Hawaii • Panama Canal • Philippine Insurrection • Access to Cuba • Roosevelt Corollary

DOK / Hess

Level 2 — The student must interpret Roosevelt's boast and connect it to the actual sequence of events in Panama — inference from a source, which is DOK-2.

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.3 · b 0.3 · c 0.2 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

—

Historian review

Sean Reynolds,

Distractor diagnosis

A — assumes the canal was contracted out to other nations; **B** — confuses Colombia with Spain as the colonial power; **C** — substitutes France for Colombia as the aggrieved party

16. Read the excerpt below. "The construction of the canal required the labor of tens of thousands of workers — Jamaicans, Barbadians, Spanish workers — in brutal tropical conditions. Yellow fever and malaria killed thousands before Dr. Gorgas brought the diseases under control." — David McCullough, *The Path Between the Seas*, 1977 Which of the following best describes a major challenge that had to be overcome to complete the Panama Canal?

- A.** Tropical disease, especially yellow fever and malaria, killed thousands of workers until a mosquito-control campaign cut the death rate
- B.** The lack of adequate explosives technology meant engineers had to rely entirely on hand-dug excavations.
- C.** The engineers had to redirect four major rivers that flooded the construction site annually.
- D.** The project faced a severe labor shortage because American workers refused to work in tropical conditions.

KEY: A · DOK 2 · US.23

Why the key is right: One of the greatest obstacles to building the Panama Canal was tropical disease — particularly yellow fever and malaria, which killed thousands of French workers in the earlier failed attempt. Dr. William Gorgas implemented a massive mosquito eradication campaign based on the theory that mosquitoes spread disease (then a new scientific understanding), which dramatically reduced the death rate and made the construction feasible. Option C is incorrect because the engineering challenge was the mountainous terrain, not river flooding (though landslides were a problem). Option D is incorrect because labor was plentiful — it was disease, not shortage of workers, that was the main challenge. Option B is incorrect because dynamite was readily available — the explosive used was a technological advance, not a limitation.

B — Dynamite and steam shovels were used extensively; the Culebra Cut was blasted, not dug by hand.

C — The Chagres River was dammed rather than redirected, and it was one river, not four.

D — There was no labour shortage: tens of thousands of Caribbean and European workers were recruited, which is what the source describes.

Item analysis

Standard

US.23 — Describe the effects of American imperialism, including: • Spanish-American War • Annexation of Hawaii • Panama Canal • Philippine Insurrection • Access to Cuba • Roosevelt Corollary

DOK / Hess

Level 2 — The student must weigh the obstacles described in the source and identify which one the evidence supports as decisive — evaluating evidence for a claim, which is DOK-2.

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.1 · b 0.1 · c 0.2 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

—

Historian review

Sean Reynolds,

Distractor diagnosis

B — assumes excavation was manual; **C** — overstates the hydrological problem and its scale; **D** — contradicts the source, which documents abundant recruited labour

17. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows the excavation of the Culebra Cut during Panama Canal construction. (Photograph, c. 1910. Public Domain.) Analyze how the construction of the Panama Canal reflected the principles of Theodore Roosevelt's approach to foreign policy.

- A. Roosevelt preferred diplomatic negotiation over action, as shown by his patient 20-year effort to gain permission from Colombia
- B. Roosevelt's 'Big Stick' diplomacy combined military readiness with assertive action, as seen in his support for Panamanian independence and unilateral canal construction
- C. The canal project demonstrated Roosevelt's isolationist beliefs and reluctance to engage in foreign affairs
- D. Roosevelt opposed the canal but was overruled by Congress, which funded the project independently

KEY: B · DOK 3 · US.23

Why the key is right: The Panama Canal epitomized Roosevelt's 'Big Stick' diplomacy: he supported Panama's secession from Colombia when Colombia rejected a canal treaty, quickly recognized the new nation, secured canal rights, and deployed American engineers and military resources. This assertive, action-oriented approach defined Roosevelt's foreign policy and expanded American influence throughout the Western Hemisphere via the Roosevelt Corollary.

Item analysis

Standard

US.23 — Describe the effects of American imperialism, including: • Spanish-American War • Annexation of Hawaii • Panama Canal • Philippine Insurrection • Access to Cuba • Roosevelt Corollary

DOK / Hess

Level 3 — *no DOK rationale — the level is a number nobody justified*

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.7 · b 0.9 · c 0.17 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

—

Historian review

not required

Distractor diagnosis

no misconception named — a distractor written to be merely wrong is noise, not diagnosis

18. Use the political cartoon to answer the question. The 1898 cartoon shows Uncle Sam at a restaurant table, with a menu listing the territories of Cuba, Puerto Rico, the Philippines, and Hawaii, and President McKinley as the waiter serving these options after the Spanish-American War. Which argument made by anti-imperialists of the time most directly challenges the decision shown in this cartoon?

- A. Governing distant territories would cost too much money and strain the federal budget
- B. The territories' populations were racially superior and deserved equal representation in Congress
- C. Annexing peoples without their consent contradicted American principles of self-government and democracy
- D. The United States should have adopted a more aggressive military strategy to control more territory

KEY: C · DOK 3 · US.23

Why the key is right: C is correct: Anti-imperialists like Mark Twain and Andrew Carnegie argued that annexing territories without the consent of their peoples contradicted American founding principles of self-government and democracy — you cannot export democracy through conquest. This argument directly challenged the casual, menu-style approach to territorial acquisition shown in the cartoon. A is incorrect: anti-imperialists were not primarily concerned with the cost of governing territories, though some raised economic objections. B is incorrect: many anti-imperialists had racial prejudices, but the main principled argument was about self-determination, not racial hierarchy. D is incorrect: anti-imperialists were opposed to overseas expansion, not arguing for a more aggressive strategy.

Item analysis

Standard

US.23 — Describe the effects of American imperialism, including: • Spanish-American War •

Annexation of Hawaii • Panama Canal • Philippine Insurrection • Access to Cuba • Roosevelt Corollary

DOK / Hess

Level 3 — *no DOK rationale — the level is a number nobody justified*

Reporting category

— (source of record: UNMAPPED)

IRT

a 1.4 · b 0.7 · c 0.2 (pre-field-test — estimates, not calibrated against student responses)

Format

classroom-formative (tcapFormat: false — not affirmed — no human has judged this item field-testable)

Bias / sensitivity

not-started

Citation

—

Historian review

not required

Distractor diagnosis

no misconception named — a distractor written to be merely wrong is noise, not diagnosis